NDC / NAIJA

NORTHSIDE DEVELOPERS COOPERATIVE

BUILDING TOGETHER. FUNDING INNOVATION. OWNING THE FUTURE.

COMPLETE COOPERATIVE FRAMEWORK + DIGITAL PLATFORM DEVELOPMENT ROADMAP

Business model | Member policies | Project financing | IP and governance | Full-stack product architecture

Research-grounded proposed blueprint • Version 1.0 • October 2026

STATUS: Proposed framework. All fees, reserves, legal classifications, lending and investment activities require adoption by members and appropriate professional or regulatory review.

00 / Executive Direction

Northside Developers Cooperative (NDC Naija) is a proposed member-owned institution for software developers and adjacent technology professionals, initially organised around Northern Nigeria. It combines cooperative savings, vetted technical collaboration, venture preparation, shared infrastructure, client work, and tightly controlled project support.

Strategic distinction: unlike a conventional savings society, NDC operates as a practical technology production and commercialisation ecosystem. Membership does not automatically guarantee project financing, employment, loans, or investment returns.

Mission / Vision / Values

Area	Statement
Mission	Help technology builders access responsible capital, trusted collaborators, market opportunities, and the infrastructure required to develop sustainable products.
Vision	A developer-led cooperative that helps commercially viable technology products emerge from Northern Nigeria for African and international markets.
Values	Member democracy; technical excellence; transparency; fair work; intellectual-property respect; inclusion; privacy; security; evidence-based decisions.

Five connected institutional functions

• Member cooperative: verified identity, share structure, contributions, voting and governance.

• Project accelerator: concept screening, validation, milestones, mentorship and go-to-market support.

• Shared development studio: paid software contracts, delivery teams and portfolio credibility.

• Technical commons: shared tooling, mentoring, code review, training and negotiated infrastructure benefits.

• Optional regulated finance: member credit, investment and external fundraising only after applicable approvals.

01 / Evidence: Why Developers Need Collective Support

Observed challenge	Evidence / implication for NDC
Competitive capital access	Africa: The Big Deal reports Nigeria startup funding of about $343m in 2025, 17% below 2024. Funding is not evenly accessible and figures are not a measure of individual developer demand.
Unfunded code maintenance	GitHub reports open-source maintainers often work without assured financial support. NDC can provide sponsorship discovery, maintenance contracts and microgrants.

Observed challenge	Evidence / implication for NDC
Limited leverage for solo builders	Platform Cooperativism Consortium describes shared capital, software ownership and democratic control as potential advantages of platform cooperatives.
Heavy early development costs	Hypothesis for member validation: hosting, devices, data, QA, security audits, sales and legal work can stall promising products. NDC should measure these needs directly.
Weak customer access	Hypothesis for member interviews: technically capable teams can struggle with procurement credibility and commercial distribution. A cooperative studio can aggregate talent.

Research is directional, not proof of demand. Before launch, interview at least 40-60 developers, 10-15 prospective buyers and 5-10 existing cooperative or innovation ecosystem operators; publish anonymised findings.

Sources informing the model

• Africa: The Big Deal (2025 funding review): https://thebigdeal.substack.com/p/2025ir2

• GitHub (2025 open-source funding research): https://github.blog/open-source/maintainers/4-trends-shaping-open-source-funding-and-what-they-mean-for-maintainers/

• Platform Cooperativism Consortium: https://platform.coop/about/benefits/technologists/

02 / Membership and Eligibility Policy

Eligible participants: frontend/backend/mobile engineers, DevOps/SRE, QA, cybersecurity, data/AI engineers, game developers, UI/UX and product designers, technical product managers, technical writers, and founders actively building software. Junior developers and students may access a non-voting learning pathway if permitted by the adopted bylaws.

Class	Rights and obligations
Full professional member	Verified professional; pays adopted membership obligations; may vote, serve in office, submit projects and join paid delivery teams subject to eligibility.
Associate / student	Training and mentorship access; no automatic voting, borrowing or project finance rights; conversion path after verification.
Corporate / partner	Organisation may sponsor challenges, provide service work or mentorship under contract; voting and share rights only if law and bylaws permit.
Honorary adviser	Advisory participation; no financial, voting or administrative privileges unless separately eligible.

Proposed admission workflow

• Identity and contact verification; portfolio/GitHub/GitLab or alternative work evidence; skill and experience declaration.

• Code of conduct, cooperative bylaws, funding-risk disclosures, privacy notice and IP commitments accepted explicitly.

- Application and dues invoicing; verified payment; committee approval; issuance of digital member card.
- Membership denial requires a stated reason and independent appeals mechanism.

Illustrative fees - not carried over automatically from NEC

Item	Proposed policy
Registration fee	To be priced after member affordability survey and operating-budget analysis; non-refundable only if lawfully disclosed and approved.
Monthly savings contribution	Member-approved tier, not an assumed flat ₦25,000; clearly accounted for as the member's withdrawable claim.
Cooperative share capital	Separate ownership instrument with legally defined rights and exit rules; not described as savings.
Project development levy	Optional, non-recoverable or risk-bearing only with separately documented consent; never silently taken from savings.
Annual renewal	Any renewal must specify cost, benefits, approval authority and grace periods.

03 / Capital Structure and Fund Separation

Non-negotiable principle: funds owed back to members must be separately recorded and safeguarded. A project that fails must not cause a hidden loss against unrelated members' withdrawable contributions.

Capital pool	Permitted purpose	Primary guardrail
Member savings liability	Recorded member contributions and approved withdrawals	Liquidity planning; no speculative venture deployment without a legal basis and express member authorisation.
Operating fund	Administration, audit, support, approved staff and platform expenses	Annual budget and spend caps.
Project development fund	Prototype grants and limited milestone support	Funded through authorised non-refundable levies, genuine surplus, grants or explicitly risk-bearing capital.
Reserve / contingency	Unexpected costs and credit/project losses	Board-approved reserve policy; periodic reporting.
Client escrow / contract receipts	Milestone payments for studio work	Contract-specific segregation and settlement accounting.
External sponsorship / grants	Programme-specific deliverables	Restricted-use terms and grant reporting.

Illustrative sustainability scenario - not forecast

At 100 active members contributing ₦10,000 per month, the system would record ₦1,000,000 in monthly member contributions. This is not ₦1,000,000 of free capital or operating revenue; it is generally an obligation to members according to the adopted savings policy. Operating income must be budgeted from separately approved fees, margins, grants, donations or other lawful sources.

04 / Developer Project Funding Programme

A technical founder submits a product that addresses a clear customer problem. NDC evaluates it with reproducible evidence and advances selected projects through gated support rather than lump-sum disbursement.

Stage	Required evidence	Decision
0 / Submission	Problem statement, target users, founder/team identities, originality declaration, IP ownership, budget, market hypothesis	Completeness check
1 / Validation	Customer interviews, competitor map, willingness-to-pay evidence, risk register	Reject / revise / proceed
2 / Technical diligence	Architecture, security/data inventory, maintainability review, delivery plan, key dependencies	Technical score
3 / Commercial diligence	Pricing, acquisition path, unit economics assumptions, procurement feasibility	Commercial score
4 / Funding committee	Conflict checks, available risk capital, exposure caps, member benefit and impact	Independent approval
5 / Execution	Signed funding or services agreement; milestone acceptance tests; spending evidence	Staged disbursement
6 / Monitoring and exit	Demo, usage evidence, financial reports, security checks, outcomes	Continue / pause / restructure / close

Project types and suitable support

Type	Suggested support
Prototype / MVP	Non-dilutive scoped microgrant, cloud credits, supervised build sprint.
Existing revenue product	Contract-backed advance or repayable facility only if legally permitted and underwriting passes.
Open-source infrastructure	Maintenance sponsorship, bug bounty, service agreements and corporate partner funding.
Community-benefit project	Restricted donor or grant sponsorship with clear impact and outcome reporting.

Type	Suggested support
Scalable startup	Investor-readiness, introductions, SEC-compliant external fundraising through approved intermediaries where applicable.

05 / Funding Committee: Scoring and Safeguards

Dimension	Weight	Indicative scoring evidence
Customer problem and demand	25%	Interview notes, paid pilots, letters of intent
Team capacity and technical delivery	20%	Portfolio, delivery plan, ownership and code quality
Commercial viability	20%	Pricing, distribution, costs and alternatives
Delivery budget and milestones	15%	Defensible procurement, acceptance tests and schedule
Legal, security and IP readiness	10%	Licences, data protections, ownership and compliance
Social/member value	10%	Jobs, skills transfer, local access and cooperative benefit

Suggested preliminary threshold: 70/100 to advance to committee discussion; a high score confers no automatic entitlement to money. Minimum gates on IP ownership, legal compliance and solvency override the score. Weights and approval thresholds require a member-approved policy.

Anti-abuse rules

• No project proposer can approve, review or reconcile their own funding. Related parties disclose interests and recuse.

• No funding into personal accounts without appropriate approved contracts and audit evidence.

• Budget changes above defined tolerances require prior authorisation; all milestone payments carry unique references.

• At least two independent decision-makers approve grants; larger exposures require board review.

• Project performance and losses are disclosed, but proprietary code and private customer data are not made public.

06 / Project Ownership, Equity and IP Policy

NDC membership does not transfer existing ideas, GitHub repositories, patents, designs or client work to the cooperative. Ownership depends on the signed project-specific legal instrument.

Arrangement	Default ownership treatment
Pre-existing founder IP	Remains with the founder; documented background-IP schedule.
Grant-funded project	Grant terms specify outputs, reporting and any limited publication licence; ownership not automatically transferred.
Loan-supported project	Repayment contract does not itself give the cooperative equity or source-code ownership.
Joint studio product	Joint-venture agreement defines creators, contributors, vesting, revenue participation, licensing and exit.
Client commission	Customer and team IP terms determined by the signed statement of work; third-party licences respected.
Open-source contribution	Repository licence, contribution policy, DCO/CLA if needed and security disclosure rules established before funding.

Essential developer protections

• Inventorship and contribution records; written assignment or licences where legally necessary.

• No automatic seizure of repos, domains, credentials or source code when a member leaves or disputes arise.

• Clear founder equity / cooperative participation terms; avoid casual or presumed 70/30 ownership splits.

• Exit terms address unvested contributions, continued maintenance, data portability and dispute processes.

• Confidentiality, non-compete and non-solicitation clauses must be proportionate and lawyer-reviewed.

07 / Studio Contracts, Revenue and Employment

NDC Studio is a proposed client-acquisition and delivery arm. It should not be advertised as guaranteed jobs. The entity signing contracts and employing/contracting teams must be determined by legal structuring.

• Business development sources leads; approved lead owner issues quotation and scope of work.

• Pricing includes development labour, QA, PM, infrastructure, taxes, risk allowance and approved cooperative service margin.

• Qualified teams chosen transparently through relevant skill matching and availability - not favouritism.

• Contracts define payment milestones, acceptance, defect warranty, IP transfer, open-source components and termination.

• Members receive their contracted compensation first under agreed schedules; cooperative margin is recognised only as earned.

• Dispute escalation goes from project lead to independent committee and then the agreed mediation/legal forum.

Suggested business revenue sources

Source	Conditions
Studio project margin	Transparent agreed commercial margin; cannot conceal deductions from developer pay.
Training and enterprise programmes	Fees for optional courses, bootcamps and company workshops.
Grant and sponsorship administration	Only allowable and disclosed programme overhead under donor terms.
Infrastructure purchasing benefits	Volume discounts shared under published terms; avoid unsupported resale claims.
Licensed products / royalties	Only where NDC contractually owns or licenses product rights.

08 / Member Conduct, Arrears and Exit Policies

Code of conduct

• Prohibit harassment, discriminatory conduct, plagiarism, malicious code distribution, credential misuse and deceptive portfolio claims.

• Require responsible disclosure of vulnerabilities, confidentiality and explicit authorisation for security testing.

• Require conflict disclosure and prohibit vote buying, forged receipts, favour trading and procurement collusion.

• Use written complaints, evidence access, independent review and proportional sanctions, subject to privacy safeguards.

Contributions and arrears

Monthly payment dates, permitted pauses, hardship relief, reminders and sanctions should be approved in bylaws. A proposed three-consecutive-month arrears trigger followed by a 30-day response window may be considered, but should not automatically confiscate savings or erase member ownership. Members must receive notice, review rights and a clear route to restore good standing.

Withdrawal and resignation

Members may request resignation and payment of eligible withdrawable balances in accordance with bylaws, liquidity planning and legal obligations. Any annual-only savings window must be conspicuous, lawful and reviewed for member fairness. Cooperative shares, savings, grants and project investments require separate settlement rules. Outstanding authorised debts and guarantees are resolved through documented procedures, not arbitrary deductions.

09 / Democratic Governance and Committee Structure

Body / role	Responsibility
General Assembly	Elect board, ratify bylaws, budgets, audits, material investment and governance policies under applicable law.

Body / role	Responsibility
Board of Directors	Strategy, risk appetite, budget, executive oversight and policy adoption.
Management / Secretariat	Membership operations, support, procurement and contract execution.
Finance / Audit committee	Statements, reconciliations, reserves, controls and independent audit coordination.
Technical Review committee	Architecture, engineering standards, cyber/data diligence, milestones.
Investment / Project committee	Project triage, funding decisions and monitored exposure.
Ethics and Disputes committee	Conflicts of interest, grievances, procedural fairness and appeals.
State chapter coordinators	Local community programmes and support; no unrestricted finance powers.

Governance policies

• One-member-one-vote as baseline where compatible with registration class and bylaws; no voting for non-members.

• Elections with published notice, eligibility, terms, secret ballot and independently reviewed tally.

• Related-party transactions require recorded disclosures, recusal and approval above policy thresholds.

• Separate initiation, approval, disbursement, bookkeeping and reconciliation roles.

• Quarterly performance disclosures and independently reviewed annual financial statements.

10 / Website Product Strategy and Experiences

Retain the NEC source roadmap’s three-environment approach but rebuild the product around technical work, not artist discovery and events. NDC needs a public presence, developer/member workspaces, and permissioned cooperative administration.

Environment	Proposed route	Purpose
Public website	ndcnaija.org (illustrative)	About, programmes, governance, developer directory, projects, partnerships and policies.
Member workspace	/dashboard	Membership, savings, skills, submitted projects, grant milestones, studio work and statements.
Administration	admin.ndcnaija.org (illustrative)	Admissions, compliance, project review, contracts, finance, audit and policy governance.

Domain names are suggestions, not availability claims. An admin subdomain is not a security boundary; enforcement belongs in server-side authorisation and database policies.

Experience principles

• Developer-first visual system: functional, calm, precise, dashboard-native, light/dark support.

• Accessible project scorecards, GitHub/GitLab links, code-related evidence and transparent finance statements.

• Clear separation between “member savings”, “grant”, “loan”, “equity”, “client revenue” and “project budget”.

• Avoid performative trading dashboards, guaranteed returns, speculative token mechanics or publicly exposed financial data.

11 / Complete Screen Inventory - 112 Proposed Screens

Product domain	Screens	Included workflows
Public website	16	Home, mission, membership, programmes, team, developers, public project directory, cases, studio, opportunities, chapters, news, contacts, FAQ, privacy and governance.
Auth and onboarding	10	Register, verify, login, reset, identity, skills, portfolio, declarations, membership payment, application status.
Member account and savings	15	Dashboard, card, profile, skills, billing, contributions, statement, withdrawals, notices, sessions and settings.
Project incubator and funding	19	Create project, canvas, validation, budget, repo, team, due diligence, scoring, review, agreement, milestones, invoices, deliverables, monitoring, risk and closure.
Studio and collaborations	13	Opportunity board, RFPs, matching, application, proposal, contract, sprint, timesheet, delivery, QA, payout, review and disputes.
Learning and community	9	Mentorship, programmes, applications, events, open-source opportunities, communities, feedback and resources.
National admin and finance	20	Verification, members, committees, permissions, invoices, payment reconciliation, savings, treasury, projects, sanctions, disclosures, reports, audit, exports.
Chapter and support	10	State dashboards, local programmes, coordinators, members, support, tickets, complaints, appeals, security notices and requests.
TOTAL	112	Planning estimate only; excludes modal and responsive variants.

12 / Core Product Workflows

A / Developer onboarding

Create account → verify contact → declare discipline / stack → link portfolio or submit work evidence → verify identity → accept legal policies → complete payment (if adopted) → membership review → activate digital card.

B / Project application

Create project → upload pitch and market evidence → register IP and team ownership → enter budget → technical checks → independent reviewers → funding committee → agreement → milestone-based fund release → performance reporting → project closeout.

C / Studio contracting

Buyer brief → NDA if required → feasibility / quote → approved scope and payment plan → talent match → contract signing → milestones → QA and acceptance → invoice / client payment → team settlement → feedback.

D / Contributions and withdrawals

Generate invoice → processor intent → gateway acknowledgement → server verifies signed webhook and transaction → atomic ledger posting → statement → withdrawal request → eligibility / liquidity approval → payout → reconciliation.

13 / Technical Stack and Integrations

Layer	Technology	Use
Language	TypeScript	End-to-end typed domain models.
Framework	Next.js App Router + React	Public marketing, member app and administration.
Styling	SCSS Modules + design tokens	Responsive custom styling; restrained soft depth instead of theatrical skeuomorphism.
Database	Supabase PostgreSQL	Operational records; double-entry ledger.
Authentication	Supabase Auth	MFA and scoped sessions.
Service logic	Next.js server modules / Supabase Edge Functions	Financial commands, reviews, queue workers.
Storage	Supabase private Storage	IDs, contracts, sensitive business artefacts.
Images and portfolio	Cloudinary	Approved public developer/project media.
Messaging	Resend + React Email	Approvals, milestones, receipts and notifications.
Payments	Paystack or Flutterwave	Verified NGN charges and authorised payouts.
External developer links	GitHub / GitLab OAuth or APIs	Optional portfolio / repository metadata with least privilege.
Charts and monitoring	Recharts + Sentry	Operational and member analytics.
Forms and testing	React Hook Form + Zod; Vitest + Playwright	Validation and regression tests.

Layer	Technology	Use
Hosting and release	Vercel + CI/CD	Preview, staging and production.

Do not request repository write access by default. Members can submit proof of work without linking accounts; private repository secrets and code should not be imported into public profile storage.

14 / Database and Ledger Architecture

Domain	Suggested tables
Identity and membership	profiles, developer_profiles, skills, portfolios, identities, consents, memberships, member_shares, renewals, chapters
Governance	roles, permissions, committees, committee_assignments, elections, votes, meetings, conflict_disclosures, policy_versions
Finance	accounts, journal_entries, journal_lines, contribution_invoices, payment_intents, payments, webhooks, reconciliations, savings_claims, withdrawals, reserves
Funding	project_submissions, founders, project_teams, ownership_declarations, diligence_reviews, funding_rounds, decisions, agreements, milestones, disbursements, reports
Studio	client_organisations, opportunities, proposals, matches, statements_of_work, deliverables, contracts, invoices, contractor_payables
Technical review	repos, architecture_reviews, vulnerabilities, assessments, acceptance_tests, audit_evidence
Community	mentorships, training_programmes, event_registrations, messages, announcements
Compliance and platform	document_access_logs, audit_logs, support_tickets, disputes, data_requests, sessions, jobs, feature_flags

Financial posting invariants

• Every posted journal must balance debits and credits; financial balances are read from the ledger, not editable front-end fields.

• Money stored as integer minor units or exact decimal; unique idempotency keys stop replayed gateway events from duplicating balances.

• Posted entries are reversed, never silently edited; gateway settlement reconciled with bank and provider statements.

• Project risk expenditure cannot be automatically sourced from member savings liabilities.

• Financial approvals require step-up MFA, dual control and well-scoped administrative permissions.

15 / Cybersecurity, Privacy and Developer Trust

• Require MFA for admins and payout approvers, rate limiting, session expiry/revocation, and device/session visibility.

• Supabase RLS on all user-scoped tables; server-side RBAC/ABAC and per-project access checks; audit every privileged action.

• Use private signed-download URLs for contracts, identity files, financial evidence and private code.

• Malware scan uploads; enforce content types/limits; avoid executing submitted code on application infrastructure.

• Separate production, staging and local credentials; secrets in server-side managers; never expose gateway secret or service-role keys.

• Conduct dependency scanning, secret scanning, penetration testing, restoration exercises and incident-response drills.

• Adopt the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023, lawful processing bases, retention schedules and subject-right workflows.

• Require security and licensing checks before releasing funded products or shipping client code.

16 / Legal and Regulatory Launch Gates

Issue	Launch decision needed
Cooperative status	Verify correct Nigerian cooperative registration route, permitted territorial scope, bylaws, share rules and Registrar oversight. Do not assume state registration authorises nationwide financial services.
Loans / credit	Obtain counsel opinion and any lending permissions; disable disbursement features until approved.
Investment / crowdfunding	Nigeria SEC crowdfunding rules apply to regulated investment-based crowdfunding; do not operate an unregistered public equity/debt funding portal.
Corporate structuring	Decide whether client contracts, product ventures and grant activities need distinct subsidiaries/SPVs and accounting boundaries.
Startup programmes	Check eligibility under Nigeria Startup Act 2022 for qualifying startup entities; cooperative membership alone does not confer startup label.
Privacy and IP	NDPA obligations, confidentiality, employment/contractor classification, source-code licences and dispute forum.
Tax and annual filings	Obtain accountant’s advice on cooperative, payroll, withholding, VAT, statutory returns and audited reports.

Regulatory sources: Nigeria SEC (https://sec.gov.ng/our-mandate/regulation/rules-and-regulations/sec-rules-for-fintechs/); Nigeria Startup Portal (https://startup.gov.ng/about); Nigeria Data Protection Commission (https://www.ndpc.gov.ng/ndp-act-2023/). Legal specifics depend on the operating state, approved bylaws and actual activity.

17 / Five-Phase Development and Organisational Roadmap

Phase	Indicative window	Required deliverables and gate
1 - Incorporation, validation, product definition	Weeks 1-4	Founder workshops; survey; legal structuring; member policy decisions; UX flows; ERD; risk register; Figma design system.
2 - Public site and membership	Weeks 5-8	Public site; onboarding; portfolio; verification; document capture; member roles; payment sandbox; initial governance and statements.
3 - Finance and administration	Weeks 9-13	Double-entry ledger; member contributions; invoices; reconciliation; committee roles; audit log; member support. Must pass financial QA.
4 - Project and studio workflows	Weeks 14-18	Applications; diligence scores; milestones; team matching; contracts; project dashboards; chapter tooling; gated finance.
5 - Security, testing and staged launch	Weeks 19-22	Pen test, UAT, accessibility, DR restore, policy publication, finance approvals, staff training and controlled production release.

22 weeks is an indicative multidisciplinary delivery plan, not a guarantee. Cooperative registration, partner contracting, and regulated finance may extend far beyond the technical build.

Release gates

Release	Feature scope	Prerequisite
MVP	Information, onboarding, professional directory, governance, contributions with correct ledger, project intake without disbursal	Registration, privacy, payment and financial-operation compliance.
v1.1	Technical review, mentorship, studio opportunities, committee workflows, audited dashboards	Operational controls and contract/IP templates.
v2.0	Milestone fund distributions, repayable finance, project JV/equity and authorised fundraising	Funding source, legal advice, licensing and explicit board/member approvals.

18 / Acceptance Criteria and KPIs

Must-pass acceptance tests

• A duplicated payment webhook cannot produce duplicate ledger postings or member activation.

• A reviewer cannot score or approve their own project, nor see another unrelated project’s confidential source code.

• Withdrawable contributions stay distinct from grants, venture losses and operating spend in every report.

• A private GitHub connection can be disconnected and removed without deleting legitimate previously approved accounting records.

• Milestone payout cannot execute without verified approvals and a signed agreement; retry never duplicates it.

• Member can download accurate contribution history and ask for access to their own data.

• Quarterly reports tie to bank/provider reconciliations; an independent test proves backup restoration.

Programme impact dashboard

Metric	Why it matters
Active members and retention	Shows community utility, not vanity registrations.
Funds available by restricted pool	Prevents confusing savings with spendable venture capital.
Projects reviewed vs financed	Measures selection rigor and access fairness.
Projects with validated paid customers	Tracks commercial outcomes beyond demo day.
Client studio revenue and paid developer hours	Measures tangible member economic opportunity.
On-time milestones and resolved security issues	Measures delivery and trust.
Loan default / project loss / liquidity ratio	Signals prudence; defined only once finance products are legally launched.

19 / Launch Documents and Operating Procedures

• Cooperative constitution, registered bylaws, membership handbook and member share schedule.

• Member savings, contribution withdrawal, arrears and reserves policies.

• Project selection manual; conflict-of-interest declarations; risk capital policy and milestone disbursement SOP.

• Grant agreements, loan forms (if legal), JV/shareholders agreements, IP assignments and licences.

• Developer studio master services agreement, statements of work, QA checklist and contractor agreement.

• Privacy notice, data processing agreement, consent register, security baseline and incident plan.

• Treasury reconciliation SOP, audit manual, role-permission matrix and complaints/appeals procedure.

• Programme evaluation templates, quarterly transparency reports and annual external audit.

Board decisions required before fee publication

• Geographic scope and headquarters jurisdiction; cooperative registration and legal name.

• Founding member eligibility, voting rights, share capital and member fees.

• Whether NDC will ever make loans or hold risk investments, and under which authorised entity.

• Maximum exposure per project, approved funding pools, reserve ratios and escalation authorities.

• Timelines for member withdrawals, refunds, dispute appeals and resignation.

20 / Final Strategic Recommendation

Launch NDC as a technology producers' cooperative with a venture support programme, not as a fintech application promising loans to everyone. The competitive proposition is the combination of trusted technical due diligence, shared earning opportunities, lawful capital access and fair member control.

Recommended sequence: validate member needs → register and adopt bylaws → launch public platform and member workspace → establish savings ledger and controls → generate studio contract income → pilot 2-3 ring-fenced projects with modest, transparent grants → measure outcomes → consider authorised lending and investment products only after governance and regulatory readiness.

A successful first-year milestone is not the largest sum collected. It is demonstrable developer income, completed projects, verified customer traction, a solvent member savings programme, and auditable trust.

Research and validation references

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